

Media Storage & Review Tools

Options comparison — Frame.io, Shade, LucidLink

COMPARISON

	FRAME.IO (CURRENT)	SHADE	LUCIDLINK
What it is	Cloud review & approval platform	AI-powered cloud NAS + media manager	Cloud-native mountable file system
Core strength	Frame-accurate client commenting, Premiere panel sync	Storage + AI search + review in one platform	Editors work directly off a mounted cloud drive, in any NLE
Storage	Upload-based — media uploaded just for review	Mountable drive, AI-indexed	Mountable drive, S3-compatible backing
Client review	Yes — this is its whole purpose	Yes, built in	No — not a review tool
Pricing	Free / \$15 / \$25 per member/mo, custom Enterprise	~\$20/seat/mo or custom	\$7–\$32/seat/mo, custom above
Replaces Drive?	No	Partially (aims to replace Drive + Frame.io + a MAM)	No — complements it

WHERE EACH ONE FITS

Frame.io — keep as-is for client-facing revision review. It's doing its job (the "Submit a Revision" flow already routes through it/ClickUp), and switching would mean giving up its deepest strength: frame-accurate client commenting.

Shade — only worth it if the real bottleneck becomes footage storage and search across old projects, not the review step. It's trying to replace Frame.io + Drive + a media asset manager all at once, which is a bigger swap than it sounds.

DECISION: NOT PURSUING — FRAME.IO ALREADY COVERS THE REVIEW STEP WELL.

LucidLink — the one worth watching. It solves a different problem than Frame.io: not client review, but editors working off shared, high-speed storage without a download/upload cycle. Cheaper entry point (\$7/seat vs. Frame.io's \$15) and it doesn't compete with anything currently in place.

HOW LUCIDLINK PAIRS WITH GOOGLE DRIVE

They're not competing — LucidLink Connect (2026) mounts your existing Google Drive directly into a LucidLink filespace. Drive content stays exactly where it is; LucidLink just streams it on demand as if it were a local high-speed drive, with no migration or duplicate copies.

In practice, that looks like:

- Editors work from the LucidLink-mounted drive during active production (fast, no download/upload cycle, works in any NLE).
- Client-facing folders and final deliverables stay in Google Drive exactly as they are today — nothing about the current client-portal Drive links changes.
- LucidLink can also back up/sync Drive content into a Filespace for consolidation, if that's ever wanted.

So adopting LucidLink wouldn't touch the Drive-based client delivery workflow already in place — it would sit underneath it, on the editing side only.

FUTURE NAS/SAN BUILD

LucidLink is designed to work with on-prem storage, not just cloud — it's explicitly built for hybrid setups. On-prem shared storage (the kind a NAS/SAN build would provide — comparable to what Avid NEXIS or SNS EVO offer) can run alongside LucidLink: local edit bays get full local-network speed straight off the NAS/SAN, while LucidLink handles remote/off-site access to the same media pool without needing a VPN or manual file transfers.

The practical options once a NAS/SAN exists:

- Run them side by side — NAS/SAN for in-office speed, LucidLink for remote access to whatever subset needs to travel.
- Point LucidLink at the NAS/SAN as its backing store, if it's fronted with S3-compatible object storage — turning the on-prem box into the origin for a LucidLink filespace everyone (local and remote) mounts the same way.

Either way, building the NAS/SAN first doesn't lock out a LucidLink decision later — worth revisiting once that hardware plan firms up.

SOURCES — Shade: [Frame.io Reviews & Pricing](https://shade.inc/blog/frame-io-review-video-production) (shade.inc/blog/frame-io-review-video-production) · [LucidLink Connect](https://lucidlink.com/connect) (lucidlink.com/connect) · [LucidLink Connect Integrations](https://lucidlink.com/blog/lucidlink-connect-integrations) (lucidlink.com/blog/lucidlink-connect-integrations) · [LucidLink: Modernize File Infrastructure](https://lucidlink.com/solutions/modernize-file-infrastructure) (lucidlink.com/solutions/modernize-file-infrastructure) · [Backup Cloud Storage to a Filespace](https://support.lucidlink.com) (support.lucidlink.com)